Transcript from National Grid Natural Gas Long-Term Capacity Report Public Meeting[1]

March 24, 2020

Coordinator: Welcome and thank you for standing by. At this time, all participants are in a listen only mode until the question and answer session of today's conference. At that time, you may press star one on your phone to ask a question. I would like to inform all parties that today's conference is being recorded. If you have any objections, you may disconnect at this time. I will now turn the conference over to Mr. John Bruckner. Thank you, sir, you may begin.

John Bruckner: Thank you, (Denise). Hello, my name is John Bruckner, I'm the president of National Grid New York. Want to welcome you to our public meeting on National Grid's long-term natural gas capacity report, which was originally scheduled in person in Brooklyn, fulfilling a provision of the company's November 2019 agreement with New York State. In that agreement, National Grid committed to researching and publishing a report that offers potential and long term solution options to address the downstate New York's recognized natural gas constraint issue.

National Grid issued this report in February of 2020 and scheduled a series of public meetings to hear from our customers and other stakeholders to understand their expectations and opinions on how we -- together -- can solve

[1] Provided by MyMeetings.

the energy challenges that face our region. And because of the outbreak of the coronavirus and in consideration of the well-being of the public and our employees, we've had to cancel the face-to-face meetings, except for the one in-person meeting that we held on March 9th in Hicksville, Long Island.

And then to provide an alternative way to help you understand the report and our findings, we've scheduled a series of virtual meetings to achieve the same objective, to share information and answer any questions that you may have on any of the options, as well as hear from me directly through an oral comment period that will be provided.

As with many companies and state agencies around the country, National Grid has activated its own business continuity plans and is in part leveraging teleconference and webinar based technologies to stay connected with our stakeholders, communities, and employees. And we step up these - set up these virtual meetings to ensure that we can still have a meaningful engagement with the public on these vital energy matters and meet our obligations to New York State to have a long-term solution -- or solutions -- in place by the winter of 2021, '22, and to meet the customer needs in New York City and Long Island.

Before we get on to the run of the show and have this national work, I'd like to provide you with some context and other important information. New York has seen dynamic economic growth in the downstate region, expanding residential and non-residential building space and thousands of oil to gas conversions over the last 10 years. These factors have resulted in a substantial increase in the demand for natural gas, placing stress on our existing gas network and threatening National Grid's ability to meet our customer needs when demand is at its peak.

This leaves little room for error in the face of unplanned supply interruptions or other contingencies. As part of the November 2019 settlement agreement with New York State that lifted the moratorium on new gas connections imposed in May of 2019, we're taking measures to ensure we have enough supply for the winters of 2019 and '20 and also 2020 through 2021, including increasing reliance on compressed natural gas, or as some call it CNG Trucking when needed to meet peak demands.

Beyond the next two winters, however, continued growth and demand for natural gas creates such a challenge that we must address. The long-term natural gas capacity reports presents 10 options to solve that challenge. It's important to note that the long-term solution options representing and the various combination of these options working together have different implications to how long we can continue to rely on CNG Trucking to meet the peak demands and whether we might have future restrictions on new gas connections.

Also of note, low carbon solutions will be an important part of reaching longer-term, clean energy goals. While formerly not part of tonight's conversation, National Grid is partnering with third parties to develop renewable natural gas solutions in which we are a leader in this space, exploring hydrogen blending and power to gas to take advantage of some of what's coming from offshore wind farms to help decarbonize the gas system.

We're also piloting geothermal heat pump solutions with partners like NYSERDA. We continue to implement clean energy solutions throughout our entire service area here in the U.S., with solar, wind, battery storage, and EV stations. All of this information can be found on our dedicated long-term capacity report Web site, ngrid.com\longtermsolutions. In addition to the full

detailed report, the Web site also features a shorter summary report to help better - help the public understand these options a little better.

To further aid in transparency and understanding, we have updated report on the Web site to include a technical appendix that lays out even more of the detail of the analysis and the assumptions, as well as estimates of how the cost of the different options would impact our customers over time. The Web site also features other methods of sharing your feedback beyond tonight's public meeting. You can take a survey to share your views on the various options and I encourage you to do so. You can also find instructions on multiple ways you can submit comments directly to the New York State Public Service Commission.

Also on the Web site, you can find information about our financial assistance programs for residential and small business customers who were inconvenienced because of the moratorium last year. Please visit the Web site and find out more information. So let's begin tonight's meeting with some guidance on how the session will work.

We will begin the session by showing you videos of each of the options with - in each of the following three categories; large infrastructure, distributed infrastructure, and non-infrastructure. After we view the complete set of videos on each of the options, we'll open the phone lines for 30 minutes of Q & A session specifically related to those options. This is the Q & A portion of the meeting. Your opportunity to ask clarifying questions on any of these options.

We have subject matter experts on the line to answer any specific questions that you may have on any of those options. I want to be clear; this will not be the time to express your views and opinion. This will only be dedicated to

asking clarifying questions on any of the options. When your line is open, we'll ask you for your name, zip code, and affiliation. Whether you are our customer or part of an organization. And then you can ask your question. In order to engage as many callers as possible during the 30 minute Q & A session, we will be limiting each caller to one question.

The Q & A session will be recorded, transcribed, and submitted -- unabridged -- to the New York State Public Service Commission. And then finally, we will open the lines for you to have an opportunity for you to have feedback and express your views during a public oral comment period. When you come on the line we'll ask you for your name, zip code, and affiliation and then you can make your statement. We will be limiting all comments to two minutes. Your comments -- again -- will be recorded, transcribed, and submitted -- unabridged -- to the New York State Public Service Commission.

One final note key to this meeting is a respectful exchange of information and ideas. While there may be some disagreement on how we get there, we're all here to solve the energy solutions that address the needs of current and future generations. And we look forward to hearing from you on how best to meet those challenges.

Okay, so now we'll screen the videos on each of the options. The videos will be played in the following order; the three large infrastructure options, which include offshore LNG deep water, LNG import terminal, and the northeast supply enhancement project. Then the four distributed infrastructure options, which would include peak liquefied natural gas facility, liquefied natural gas barges, the Cove Lakes transmission loop project, and the Iroquois enhancement by compression project. And then three non-infrastructure projects and options, which will include energy efficiency, demand-side management, and electrification.

As you view and listen to the videos, please get your questions ready. Once we complete viewing and listening to all of the videos on each of the options, we'll begin the 30 minute Q & A period. You will need to press star one to get into the queue to ask your questions. Thank you and please play the first set of videos.

Man 1: We will now play the videos for the large - three large infrastructure options.

((VIDEO))

Man: Offshore LNG deep water port involves the installation of an offshore buoy connected to one of the existing undersea pipelines that currently supply the downstate New York region. Connected to this buoy would be a floating storage and regasification unit and LNG bulk delivery ship. This ship can store more than 3 million dekatherms of LNG and then vaporize it for injection into the pipeline to accommodate peak demand and potentially help meet daily demand during the year.

Unlike the gas pipeline solution, this option stores a finite amount of natural gas and is replenished via ship to ship transfers. There are two potential locations where this could be installed. One on the Long Island Sound and the other in the Atlantic Ocean off the rockaways. Viewshed impact should be minimal given the distance from the shore. Each location would be capable of delivering 400,000 dekatherms per day capacity. If this option comes to pass, it's highly reliable.

What would the impact be on the environment? During construction the impact includes disturbance of the sea floor, decreased water and air quality, increased sedimentation, noise, and waste generation. Once operational, the

floating storage and regasification unit and refueling tanker can be expected to generate stack and cooling water emissions, greenhouse gas, GHG emissions from an LNG system present a climate impact 10 to 15% greater than a standard natural gas solution. Given its offshore location, the community impacts of this option should be minimal. We expect full implementation of this option with six to eight years.

If you're read the report, you know, each option carries some execution risks and considerations. Until this infrastructure comes online, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand and we'd have to implement a series of incremental energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification measures to further reduce demand. If these measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines before the infrastructure comes online, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

We estimate the total cost of this option -- including the infrastructure and the demand side program -- to be 1.9 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.22 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

((VIDEO))

Woman: A liquefied natural gas -- or LNG -- terminal involved building the infrastructure necessary to accommodate LNG carrier ships, including an LGN receiving facility, onshore storage, regasification, and transportation components. Such a facility would be able to accommodate peak demand and help meet daily demand during the year. It would provide 400,000 dekatherms per day of natural gas capacity. This is a highly reliable option,

however it is more vulnerable to severe weather events than the floating LNG and LNG barge options we've presented. This is an option used all over the world and National Grid has experience with LNG facilities both here in the U.S. and in the U.K.

What would the impact on the environment be? It would be equivalent or slightly higher than those associated with the offshore LNG deep water port and higher than pipeline development. Greenhouse gas emissions would have a climate impact of 10 to 15% greater than a standard natural gas solution. There would be significant impact to the community resulting from construction and operation. And, before it ever came to pass, it would require changes to or a waiver of existing New York State law that limits land storage of natural gas.

Pending this necessary change to the law, we estimate the timeline for this option to be five to six years. If you're read the report you know each option carries some execution risks and considerations. Until this infrastructure comes online, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand and we'd have to implement a series of incremental energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification measures to further reduce demand.

If these measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines before the infrastructure comes online, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. We estimate the total cost of this option -- including the infrastructure and the demand side programs -- to be 2.46 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.78 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

((VIDEO))

Man: The Northeast Supply Enhancement -- or NESE project -- involves the construction of an interstate pipeline by Williams Companies Incorporated to transport natural gas from Pennsylvania to New York through New Jersey via the Raritan By and lower New York Bay. The pipeline would include approximately 23.5 miles -- approximately 17 in New York -- of underwater pipeline to the Rockaway Peninsula in Queens. It would provide the downstate region with 400,000 dekatherms per day of natural gas capacity.

This option is extremely reliable and fundamentally resistant to above ground weather events. The environmental impact of construction would be similar to offshore LNG deep water port, albeit over a larger geographic area. This impact includes disturbance of the sea floor, decreased water and air quality, increased sedimentation, noise, and waste generation. Ongoing operations will have a much lower effect on the environment and greenhouse gas emissions are expected to be 10 to 15% lower than any of our LNG options.

Community impacts would be minimal, with most of the construction happening offshore. There is some onshore construction in New Jersey in ground field sections in William's existing footprint. In the future, the carbon steel pipeline material would allow hydrogen to be transported, helping significantly assist with carbon reduction goals. Assuming the option receives New York State and New Jersey permit approval by June 2020, we estimate this project can come online by December 2021.

Because this has the fastest estimated infrastructure timeline and once in place has very high reliability, it provides the highest degree of certainty that there will not be restrictions on new customer connections and once the infrastructure is online, we would be able to mothball compressed natural gas

trucking and reduce some contracted peaking supplies, which would eliminate a source of supply with higher emissions and provide us with some contingency capacity. This option would cost 1.82 billion in the low demand scenario and 1.83 billion in the high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

Man 1: We will now play the videos for the four distribute infrastructure options.

((VIDEO))

Woman: A peak liquefied natural gas -- or LNG -- facility is one of our distributed infrastructure options. It would involve construction of a new LNG peak shaving facility plant and related infrastructure like what we already have in Greenpoint, Brooklyn and Holtsville, Rhode Island. This is a highly reliable option and is in use throughout the United States. We have 12 of these facilities across our Massachusetts, Rhode Island, and downstate New York service areas.

But to get this option up and running would require a change to or waiver of New York State law that limits land storage of natural gas. Once online, this option can potentially provide up to 100,000 dekatherms per day to meet periods of peak demand. The environmental impact for this project would be moderate, including decreased air quality, pollution to storm water and other runoff, disruption to natural resources and habitats, noise, and waste generation.

It does, however, have a smaller footprint compared to our larger infrastructure LNG options. This option would have to be sited within a community, most likely within an industrial zone. This option would have

greenhouse gas emissions similar to our other LNG options and 10 to 15% higher than standard natural gas solutions. But remember, this option would only run to meet peak day demands. Assuming change or a waiver from current New York law, it's estimated a new site would be operational in five to six years.

This option does carry some execution risks and considerations until it comes online. Because this solution only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take five to six years to come online, it would need to be paired with a series of near term and ongoing incremental energy efficiency demand response and electrification measures. If these demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The estimated total cost of this option -- including both the infrastructure and the demand side programs -- is 1.49 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.54 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

((VIDEO))

Man: Liquefied natural gas -- or LNG -- barges are one of our four distributed infrastructure long-term options. This option involves the purchase and construction of one or more specialty LNG barges with vaporization equipment on board. These barges would be towed to locations to allow them to transfer LNG from a variety of land and sea-based sources and inject vaporized gas into the existing onshore pipeline. This option can provide

potentially up to 50,000 dekatherms of peaking capacity per barge. If used in tandem, total supply would double to 100,000 dekatherms per day.

This is a reliable option and the barges can be strategically placed in multiple locations, assuming permit approvals. The environmental impact would be similar to the LNG port solution, but at a smaller scale, with disturbances of the sea floor, decreased water and air quality, increased sedimentation, nose, and waste generation. The only construction required is a new pier and short pipeline to an existing onshore connection. In addition, there would be visual impact to water views during the winter and there may be loss of waterside recreation use in the immediate are due to the size of the barge system and security perimeter developed during the siting process.

We estimate the total implementation time for this project to be five to six years. Because this solution only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take five to six years to come online, it would need to be paired with a series of near-term and ongoing incremental energy efficiencies, demand response, and electrification measures to reduce demand and completely close the gap. If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The total estimated cost of this option -- including both the infrastructure and the demand side program -- is 1.36 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.42 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

((VIDEO))

Woman: Clove Lake Loop Transmission project is one of our distributed infrastructure long-term options. It would involve construction of approximately eight miles of new 30-inch steel transmission main across the borough of Staten Island. It will help our ability to take more gas through the (unintelligible) take station. And ultimately move more gas across our system to supply constrained areas. When complete, it can provide approximately 70 to 100,000 dekatherms per day of base load capacity to support daily demand. And it would be used to support the system year-round.

This is a historically very safe and reliable method of transporting natural gas. Most of the environmental impact will come from construction. It would involve installation of a new gas main across sections of the heavy populated urban environment and would possibly impact multiple highways and/or small water crossings during installation. Because of the proposed route, we would need a mitigation plan to minimize disruption to residents, businesses, and traffic.

Once operational, the impacts will be minor, as little ongoing maintenance will be required. Greenhouse gas emissions will be comparable to similar gas mains in the current distribution system. Once operational, this option will have lower emissions than the liquefied natural gas options or compressed natural gas trailers and trucking. Initial estimates indicate that this option could be in service by November 2025 at the earliest, making the timeline five plus years.

Because this option only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take five plus years to come online, it would need to be paired with a series of near-term and ongoing incremental energy efficiency, demand

response, and electrification measures to reduce demand to completely close the gap. If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand.

The total estimated cost of this option -- including both the infrastructure and the demand side programs -- is 1.57 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.63 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

((VIDEO))

Man: The Iroquois Enhancement by Compression project is one of our distributed infrastructure long-term options. It would involve the construction of additional compression facilities to increase capacity on the Iroquois gas transmissions systems -- IGTS -- existing infrastructure. To transport natural gas from the U.S./Canadian border at Waddington, New York through the existing system located in New York State and Connecticut to be existing interconnection with our gas distribution system at Comec, Long Island.

When complete, this option can provide up to approximately 125,000 dekatherms per day of base load capacity. We would split this capacity with ConEd, so we would each add 62.5 thousand dekatherms per day to our respective systems. This would enhance reliability to our system, especially to the gate delivery point serving our most eastern-bound customers.

Above ground weather events and man-made events such as traffic and automobile accidents would not impact the availability of the natural gas supply. This option will have a moderate impact on the environment. As construction will take place on an already existing line, the impact will be focused on locations already developed. As part of this project, Iroquois plans to further reduce methane and overall emissions at sites by installing low-nitrogen oxide NOX turbine units that will reduce NOX emissions by 40% over standard turbine units. Potential greenhouse gas emissions will also be mitigated by Iroquois' proposal to install methane recovery systems.

All permitting, policy, and regulatory requirements must comply with FRQ regulations and other appropriate federal, state, and local agencies. The project filed a formal application with the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission in February 2020 and is expecting a decision on approval by early 2021. Assuming timely approvals, the project could be in service by November 2023.

Because this solution only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take three years to come online, it would also be paired with a series of near-term and ongoing incremental energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification measures to reduce demand to completely close the gap. If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The total estimated cost of this option -- including both the infrastructure and the demand side programs -- is 1.11 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.22 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

Man 1: We will now play the videos for the three non-infrastructure options.

((VIDEO))

Woman: Incremental energy efficiency is one of our non-infrastructure long-term options. It would involve building a pond and expanding the base and incremental new efficiency New York programs with some more aggressive program offerings that reduces annual energy consumption and design day demand. It will focus on gas efficiency savings, with a key focus on intensive weatherization measures and will require extensive customer and trade ally engagement and training.

This option can potentially provide 111 to 216,000 dekatherms of design day savings. When implemented, this option will lead to passive energy and design day savings. It's key, however, that we're able to ramp up quickly and start realizing impact by winter of 20201, '22. There is no additional environmental impact, as work will only be completed on existing structures.

Overall, this would result in a reduction of greenhouse gas emissions through less natural gas consumption. To be successful, we'll need to further develop a wide range of contractors and suppliers who will need to hire additional employees to support the spending over the duration of the program. These investments will go directly into the downstate economy and any bill savings will go directly to customers.

This option will require a significant increase in level of effort across the entire energy efficiency network, including growth in umber of contractors,

staff in local permitting offices, and increases in company employees. The program would have to scale up by 2025 to become similar in size to our current successful program in Massachusetts. This solution requires a series of incremental energy efficiency demand response and electrification measures that start to have predictable impact on peak demand by the winter of 2021, '22 and continue to grow their impact as a size and pace that enables existing National Grid gas supply to meet customer needs.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The total estimates cost for this option is 1.51 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.62 billion in our high demand scenario. This includes the total cost for the entire no-infrastructure portfolio of energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification required to close the gap between supply and demand.

((END VIDEO))

((VIDEO))

Man: Demand response is one of our non-infrastructure long-term options. Compared to other non-infrastructure options, demand response is more cost effective and can be ramped up more quickly. That's because demand response will leverage existing equipment at customer premises. The overall challenge with this option is related to the overall number of eligible customers we have and the challenges that multi-family and commercial customers have in maintaining a backup source of heat -- typically fuel oil -- for use in temperature control or non-firm programs.

Those who fall under the temperature control category include those multi-family and some commercial and industrial customers who we ask to switch off of natural gas and move to another fuel source -- typically fuel oil -- when the temperature drops below a certainly level. For example, 16 degrees Fahrenheit. We also have thermostat setback programs where we provide an incentive for residential customers to turn down their thermostats during cold weather events.

Implementing this option would require new rate design programs that encourage these customers to remain on non-firm rate programs. If implemented, we estimate approximately 81 to 108,000 dekatherms of design day savings. One of the risks with this option is that there is no guarantee that customers will switch to their alternate fuel, as they can still use natural gas. Accordingly, the number of participants during an event can fluctuate and not meet projections, thereby putting reliability at risk. We feel, however, this could improve over time as the demand response program matures.

There is little or no incremental impact to the environment with this option. In addition, there will be a limited impact to the climate as demand response will reduce energy use during peak periods, but some of this displaced energy will swing to non-peak periods. Meanwhile, non-firm customers switching to an alternate fuel -- typically fuel oil -- will result in higher greenhouse gas emissions. In the future, fuel oil could be transitioned to renewable fuels -- such as bio fuels -- which would help reduce environmental impact.

This option requires New York Public Service Commission approval, including incentives and total investments before the program can begin and it will impact permitting, policy, and regulatory activities at the local and state level. This solution requires a series of incremental energy efficiency, demand

response, and electrification measures that start to have predictable impact on peak demand by the winter of 2021, '22 and continue to grow their impact at a size and pace that enables existing National Grid gas supply to meet customer needs.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The total estimates cost of this option is 1.51 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.62 billion in our high demand scenario. This includes the total cost for the entire no-infrastructure portfolio of energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification required to close the gap between supply and demand.

((END VIDEO))

((VIDEO))

Woman: Electrification is one of our long-term non-infrastructure options. This option presents us with an opportunity to reduce design day natural gas consumption by converting customer's space heating energy source from natural gas to electricity. We could achieve this by using cold climate heat pumps, which operate efficiently even at cold temperatures and they can be installed and operated without a fossil fuel backup heating system. If we assume a robust incentive program is in place and effective, incremental electrification can yield a range of 52 to 86,000 dekatherms per day in design day demand reduction.

To achieve these reduction levels, we estimate we'll need 5,000 to 15,000 incremental customers per year starting in 2021 to move to electric heat, cooking, and industrial use. Once implemented, this is a reliable option to reduce forecasted design day demand. It's important to know that if customers retain gas for other uses, however -- such as for cooking, water heating, or as a backup heating source -- the design day savings will be less than anticipated.

There is minimal current environmental impact with this option. However, the reduction of gas consumption will be largely offset by an increase in electricity consumption, with some studies showing higher current emission for electric power than natural gas in the short-term. Longer-term, due to the forecasted decarburization of New York's electric supply, incremental electrification will result in decreased emissions.

For electrification to really take hold, we'll need to create an ecosystem that will include a wide range of contractors and suppliers who will need to hire additional employees to support the spending over duration of program and it will mean growth in total electric customers and electric demand, requiring permitting, policy, and regulatory requirements to be in place, equating to significant startup costs and resources.

The biggest challenge with electrification right now is both the upfront and ongoing cost. The current cost of installation is often twice as high as the typical natural gas heating unit. In addition, electric prices are relatively high in downstate New York and would likely lead to overall increase in customer's annual energy utility bill. For this option to be economic in this region, we'd have to see big increases in heat pump efficiency or big reductions in electric prices.

Electrification requires a series of incremental energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification measures that start to have predictable impact on peak demand by the winter of 2021, '22 and continue to grow their impact at a size and pace that enables existing National Grid's natural gas supply to meet customer needs. Note, if the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The total estimates cost of this option is 1.51 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.62 billion in our high demand scenario. This includes the total cost for the entire no-infrastructure portfolio of energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification required to close the gap between supply and demand.

((END VIDEO))

Man 1: John, the videos on each of the options is now completed.

John Bruckner: All right, thank you, (Bill). But also thank you all for that - for being connected. I know that's a long time to listen to those videos. But again, it's really to lay out all of the options that are out there. To hear your questions and to give you a good comprehensive review of all of those options. So I apologize for the length of time, but it is important that all of the listeners have an opportunity to become familiar with the various options, especially now as we open up the Q & A session.

So again, the Q & A session will last 30 minutes. It'll be followed by a public comment period. So if we run out of questions coming in, it'll give us more

opportunity to have a longer public comment period. Again, we have subject matter experts on the line to answer specific questions about any particular option that was cited in the report. I want to be clear, this isn't the time to express a view or an opinion. We will get to that after the Q & A period. But we want to give everyone an opportunity to ask any questions that they have about the options so that they become more familiar with them. And then we certainly will open it up to a public comment period.

With that, when your line is open ask - you'll be asked your name, zip code, and affiliation and then ask your question. All right? So operator, can we go to the first question, please?

Coordinator: Thank you. And please press star one on your phone and unmute your phone line and record your name in order to introduced with your question. One moment for the first question. The first question comes from (Kim Fraucheck) and please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Kim Fraczek): Hi, (Kim Fraczek), Sane Energy Project, and my zip code is 11206. And my question to you is asking you if you actually think that this is a relevant way of engaging with the public in claiming that this is an opportunity for us to see the work that you're doing? I mean that as an honest question and I find this absolutely insulting to our democracy, to the order that Governor Cuomo gave you, and I want to know if you actually think that this is a legitimate community engagement process.

John Bruckner: Thank you, (Kim). Look, I think it's a great question. And as I said at the start, we began the process of having public meetings so that we could hear from you and have an opportunity to be face to face. And in light of coronavirus, we didn't want to just cancel the meetings, right? We wanted to still give the public an opportunity to hear what's going on and utilize the

technology that's available to us. So while we would - I believe would have preferred a public face to face meeting as we had done in Hicksville, this offered the next best possible solution.

So again, your comment is certainly welcome and if you, you know, choose to do so you can certainly offer your comment at the end after the 30 minute question and answer period. Or, again, submit your comment directly to the Web site and to the New York State Public Service Commission. Thank you.

Coordinator: Next question comes from (Robert Wood). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Robert Wood): 350 Brooklyn, 11238. Are you there?

John Bruckner: Yes, (Robert).

(Robert Wood): So your greenhouse gas assessment of the Williams pipeline is based on a report by MJ Bradley that uses completely discredited and completely misleading data on methane. The conclusions it reached - reaches are based on methane's 100-year (unintelligible) potential rather than its 20-year (unintelligible) potential. When methane is basically 86 times more powerful than carbon dioxide as a greenhouse gas.

The report also uses the Department of Energy's discredited data on methane leakage rather than more recent data, which shows that methane leakage is something like 60% greater than was thought. I should mention that the report actually does mention the correct data, but it consigns it to an appendix. So can you explain to the people on this call, why you're basing your emissions assessment of a billion-dollar pipeline on completed discredited data?

John Bruckner: (Unintelligible), I guess that's two questions there. So (John) with respect to, (John Locko) with respect to the NESE Project if there's anything you would like to add, but first let me ask (Cameron) just to respond to the use of the data and the assumptions in the report. So (Cameron)?

(Cameron): Sure, so thanks (John). So, you know, in our report we've outlined a couple of different ways of looking at the emission and ways of looking at the environmental impact. So in the section of the report where we talk about our assumptions for evaluating environmental impacts, we do look at both the marginal emissions and then we actually also look at both the 100-year emissions and the 20-year emissions and provide comparisons regarding the emissions for all of the different sort of types of fuel and types of energy including electrification.

We then also in the options, we discuss the environmental impact in each of the options and that comes down to both the impact of something that may be occurring as you're putting the option in place, into service as well as the ongoing emissions that could be resulting from that option. So we really try to present, you know, all of the different impacts. And I'll stop there.

(John): All right thank you (Cameron). (John) was there anything specific to the project that you wanted to add?

(John): No, (John).

(John): Okay, very well, thank you.

Coordinator: The next question is from a person with the Food and Water Action. I'm sorry I did not catch your name. Go ahead and give us your ZIP code and your name.

(Laura Shindell): This is (Laura Shindell). My ZIP code is 10019. Am I able to ask multiple questions or were you come back to me as long as there's time permitting?

(John): Yes, I mean a couple things (Laura). As long as they're about the options during the Q&A period.

(Laura Shindell): They are.

(John): If you have a couple questions about various options, that would be fine.

(Laura Shindell): Yes, they are. So I'll start with the first one. I actually tried to ask this question last night and the operator took my name, but you all announced that all the questions had been taken after the first video. But in several of the scenarios, the offshore LNG, the video for the NESE pipeline, Scenario 5, Scenario 9, you reference continuing the CNG truck or retaining the CNG trucks. My question is not true that though you had CNG trucks ready to be operational this year, none of them were, in fact, used or necessary due to warmer weather which of course is due to climate change caused by fossil fuels. And so aren't you misleading the public in these presentations by asserting that the CNG trucks were used this past winter and we'd be continuing usage when they, in fact, weren't deployed?

(John): So (Laura) what we'll do is have your first question with respect to the CNG trucks and I'll have (Pete) give us a response to that. But before we do, do you want to just make sure that I'm aware of what your other questions are?

(Laura Shindell): Sure, so my other questions are if there's a passage in the report that says though you went into - you took environmental considerations into consideration for the various proposals that they were not analyzed to how

they would meet the greenhouse gas reduction mandates of the CLCPA. So I'm wondering why that piece was omitted from each of the scenarios for how each scenario would meet the CLCPA mandates. And …

(John): Okay.

(Laura Shindell): …my third question is more process-oriented. Last night when we joined, we were briefly able to see that over 160 participants had joined the meeting before the settings on your end were changed and we were no longer allowed to see that information. And then later in the meeting, when somebody asked in their public comments how many people were left in the queue, you declined to answer. So my question tonight is if you can let us know how many participants were on the call last night? How many are on tonight? In the spirit of an open and transparent process.

(John): All right, so those are the three questions. So I'm going to have (Pete) address the CNG trucking. You had a question with respect to the environmental reports and it's the impact with CLCPA and its impact on the study. And I'm going to have (Cameron) answer that. And then I will ask if (Bo) or (Steve) or someone can answer the question with respect to the - I'm not actually controlling the telephonic so I'll have to defer that and see if we can have someone chime in on the calls and whether it's the operator and so forth. So I think those are your three questions. So (Pete) can we just have some, an answer with respect to the CNG trucking issue?

(Pete): Sure thing, the CNG trucking option was designed specifically to meet peak hour design needs on a peak day. And as you noted the, weather this winter was warmer than a normal winter. We need to be prepared every winter to meet the design day criteria that the system has to be able to meet to keep all of our firm customers in service, warm and safe. If we do not have the CNG

trucking option available to us, we will not be able to do that. We did, however, deploy the CNG trucking option in February in order to ensure that it would operate as planned and we did have those trucks come out, operate and dispatch back to their original place with no incidents. Thank you for your question.

(John): But (Pete) I guess the question also is that doesn't necessarily mean it could not or would not be needed.

(Pete): No, it absolutely would have been needed under a design day condition. We would have required both sites to be operating at full capacity had a design day occurred in the winter of 2019/2020. And we will have increased needs in CNG trucking for the upcoming 2020/2021 winter based on the projected growth that we're looking to see. So there is absolutely no doubt.

(John): And it, yes. In addition to continue to use, I would add to that as well. But let's move on to the environmental report. (Cameron) with respect to the CLCPA and how that's addressed is the report

(Cameron): Yes, so with regard to the CLCPA, this report did not do a 30-year environmental study of how the state was going to, you know, achieve the CLCPA requirement. We do believe that there are a number of different pathways and options that are available to potentially meet, you know, as far as ways that you can meet those requirements. We do highlight and talk about some of the different environmental impacts of the different options. I think it's also worth noting as we did in the report that there are multiple other studies that have been looking at how people are going to decarbonize and there's multiple studies that are showing that a combination of utilizing gas network as well as utilizing heat electrification is a way that you can achieve

goals and do so at the lowest overall cost versus options that are, you know, entirely focused on electrification for example.

So we think there are different options here that people are, that we are actively looking at how we can help drive things towards meeting those goals and that those are consistent with different options for what needs to be done to meet the demand in downstate New York.

(John): And so (Cameron), just two things in addition to the study that you referenced, we're also in an agreement with Con Ed and New York City with preparing an assessment with respect to how to attain their goals. So many of these studies are going on. And can you just share with the callers what National Grids target is currently for the reduction of greenhouse gas emissions?

(Cameron): Yes, so it's well I mean we're target focused on 80% reduction. And, you know, we think that in a lot of places it's, you know, something that we're well underway in terms of studying and in terms of taking action to drive towards.

(John): All right, thank you (Cameron) and just lastly the last part of the questions was with respect to the call and the call volume. I would just reach out. I'm not sure if the operator has that information, but by the end of the call if we could get that information out, that would be helpful. All right.

Coordinator: All right, the next question comes from (Jean Belford). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Jean Belford): Hi, it's with (Rockaway Women for Progress) and it's 11694. I am calling really also about the process. Living in Rockaway right after Hurricane Sandy there was all of the planning and strategizing and voting and public comment

period went completely under the radar for the people in Rockaway. Because it was right after Hurricane Sandy and we were displaced and homeless and rebuilding. And this process would have potentially been something that we could have participated in. However, even before coronavirus came to New York, there was not one public comment period or a meeting that was going to be taking place in Rockaway or anywhere close to Rockaway. So once again, we're on the frontline of the environmental impact and no one in Rockaway even knows about this and how this process is taking place virtually and people are completely, you know, not in a position right now to pay attention to this.

Then also I'm noticing that as I'm on the phone with you, you're not recording on the video. I don't know is there a recording of this for memorialization purposes? Because as we're talking I don't even have the luxury of looking back at the scenarios and the slides. So it's very disconnected for me. And as a citizen, I'm concerned. Going forward is this going to be - is this an added bonus? Or is this going to be, we're going full steam ahead and we're acting as if this is the process? The Olympics are postponed.

(John): (Unintelligible) couple question there.

(Jean Belford): Yes.

(John): I think there's a couple questions there. Let me make sure I captured them and then, again, at this point I'll answer those questions. But I just want to make sure we stay focused on the options and then you'll certainly have an opportunity during the public comment period as well. But a couple questions that you asked. First of all with respect to the options, the Web site has that information on it. So you can always go to the Web site and access that

information on the options. It's there for you. Not just during the call, so you can always go back and take a look at that.

As far as recording the call, the calls are being recorded and it is being kept on file and it's also being shared with the public service commission, the New York State Public Service Commission. So those two - that certainly addresses your first two questions.

With respect to tonight's session as opposed to the in-person session that we did have the opportunity to hold in Hicksville. As I mentioned at the start of the call, the in-person opportunity to come out there is always a better option. It just doesn't avail itself to us today for the reasons that we discussed. It's certainly in all of our best interest not to gather in a large group today or tonight and have this conversation from a public health perspective.

So you're right. It's not the best option, but it's the next best option available. And I just think from a participation perspective I understand that each location that we were scheduled to have these meetings, it's a different dynamic. I understand that. What I will say is that the number of people that joined last evening's call which was scheduled to take place on Long Island was far in excess of the number people who showed at the meeting that we did have.

So I'm not saying that's a proxy for all of them, but what I am saying is the number of participants on this option of a call seemed to attract more people than the in-public by multiple numbers. So again, it's not, you're right. It's not the best option, but I do believe it's the next best option. Operator?

Coordinator: Next is (JK Canepa). Please state your affiliation and your ZIP code.

(JK Canepa): Hello, I'm (JK Canepa) from (Sane Energy Project). My ZIP code is 10009. So I have a question. I have a few questions. One of them is on your presentation on electrification. And electrification is being presented as something that is unattainable, expensive. I ask you why there was no mention of battery storage of electrification derived from renewable energy as a form of addressing the purported shortage of energy for New York?

I also have a question about the increased need for a Compressed National Gas trucking on those, on the design day. As I said last night, why did you go back 86 years to find the very worst-case scenario of zero degrees for 25 hours. I mean why didn't we go back 10,000 years and dig into the previous ice age and see how terrible it could have been and planned for that? And finally, about (Robert Woods) question on methane leakage. Again, the numbers are just astonishingly that you're bringing up the hundred-year comparison between methane as a greenhouse gas and carbon dioxide as a greenhouse gas, a hundred years in the future. When it's been presented to us that you're not even looking 30 or 20 years in the future. You're looking at the next five years. So I don't understand the reference to 100-year and a 20-year comparison of methane as a potent greenhouse gas.

(John): So, (JK), thank you for your questions. And I just want to make sure that I captured them. And I believe I have, but I'll make sure as we go through them. But you have a question about electrification and why we, you know, the assertion was made that we're saying that it's overly expensive, well and so forth. So I'll have (McKenzie) address that. But we do believe before we had it to (McKenzie), we do believe that electrification certainly plays a role and a significant role. And we want to make sure we understand that.

You talked about battery storage and renewables. You didn't say offshore wind, but when I think about renewables. I think of renewable natural gas.

And I also think of renewables in the space of offshore wind. Recognizing the amount of focus and really the lead that New York State is in under Governor Cuomo with respect to advancing offshore wind. It's a tremendous asset for all of us going forward.

So I'll just mention something about that. You also mention the National Gas Trucking issue, and I'll have (Pete) again reaffirm your concerns on that. And then very quickly (Cameron) if you would talk about methane.

But let me talk about battery storage. You mentioned battery storage, (JK) and you know, I'm very proud of the work that National Grid has done with battery storage. Battery storage I would say that National Grid and our service territories and I can give you some examples, we have truly embraced battery storage for a number of reasons. Number 1, from a ratepayer perspective, it clearly reduces the rates to customers because we can utilize battery storage and not make those large investments in infrastructure especially on the electric side.

Now downstate it's a little different. The state owns the electric facilities, but in partnership with (Lypa), we did respond to their RFP for battery story and in partnerships with other private companies, we've developed and put in service a number of battery storage operations in East Hampton and in Montauk. And again, that reduces the capital investment that otherwise would have been needed in infrastructure and gives us the ability to have enough generation or energy to supply customers during those peak times during the summer.

So we have embraced it. As a matter of fact, even off of Long Island, National Grid up in Massachusetts has installed the largest battery storage facility on the island of Nantucket. Again, clean energy, taking advantage of that and

also reducing rates to our customers in that region. In upstate New York, we've done the same. We've been leaders in looking to offset capital investment and assets. In, you know, large transmission and electric assets and utilizing battery storage.

You mentioned renewables and again, I think, you know, in recognition of Governor Cuomo's position on offshore land, New York is clearly out in front in the US on offshore wind. And we really believe that we've embraced the opportunity that's there with offshore wind to take advantage of it not only to have clean electricity, but also starting with university and National Grid have partnered on a number of studies with respect to how to convert that excess electricity into clean gas that can be stored.

You can store some of the electricity in batteries, but again, the amount of wind that we expect coming from offshore, will greatly exceed our demand many times and we could use that - those assets to store it in a clean fashion. So much going on in the way of offshore wind, battery storage, and even renewable natural gas in the way of landfill gas that otherwise would be emanating out of those landfills. We're capturing that, cleaning it and utilizing that. As a matter of fact downstate, I don't know if you're familiar with New Town Creek. It's the largest wastewater treatment facility in the State of New York. We have a partnership. It's a unique partnership with the city where the gas that comes out of that process of theirs is actually cleaned, purified and put back into natural gas system in lieu of being flared off.

So there's a number of things we're doing in that space. At this point, I'd ask (McKenzie) to talk a little bit about electrification.

(McKenzie): Yes, thank you, (John) and thank you for the question. So two things about electrification. First, what we put into the baseline assumptions, the base case,

and then what we put into consideration with the solution of electrification as a part of the distributed solution set. So in the baseline, we did assume that there's a pretty significant amount of electrification that would take place. This is in part due to changes in the market. It's also in part due to changes in policy. So based on the new efficiency in New York decision, we expect to see pretty significant growth in electrification because now electric utilities have targets associated with the deploying electrification of a solution. So that was included in the base case which further reduced the demand forecast that we're working with in the report.

In addition to that, we expected some additional growth in electrification just based on retrofits and home renovations and end of life for existing equipment in homes. So we saw and we expect to see electrification play a bigger role in the future as outlined in the report.

And then looking at electrification as an incremental solution to help us address that additional growth and demand that was outlined in the report. You make excellent points about considering all renewables. We really focused on addressing the issue of heating in this report. And when it comes to electrification of heating that really had to be done on the customer premises. And when it comes to the cost of it, that was used to make those assumptions, we relied on existing performance of the market today. So the cost of equipment, the cost of installation and then also the cost of operation that we've seen in the market today.

So there are limitations to a technology based on the cost in the report with the solution we had to make assumptions about how we would incentivize that equipment and how we would incentivize the use of that equipment to encourage customer adoption. But there are ultimately limitations to how much you can deploy a solution because of cost. But certainly electrification

is something that we're expecting to see more of in the future as outlined in the report.

(John): All right, thank you. And (Pete) if you could in very short order, just again, address if there's anything else you wanted to add from the earlier comment about the trucking.

(Pete): The trucking is really there to meet the peak hour and peak day needs. We select the timeframe that we had, not just because National Gird uses it. It's actually used across a number of utilities and in the mid-Atlantic region including our neighboring utility, Con Edison. And others that are int his particular bandwidth. We actually have a -10 threshold that we use for upstate New York. It's important to note that just like we have to worry about 100-year flood and a 500-year flood. We also have to worry about 100-year temperature ranges. If you don't plan for a 500-year flood range of a 100-year flood range, we have seen what can happen when that happens.

So we have to take that into account. Also unlike the electric industry, there are no reserves on the gas industry. You do not have spinning reserves or things of that nature. So you need to have CNG available to meet those peak hour needs because you cannot move gas across the entire country in a matter of minutes like you can with electricity. Thank you for your question.

(John): Thank you, (Pete). Operator, next question.

Coordinator: That is from (Kevin LaCherra). Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Kevin LaCherra): Sure, My name is (Kevin LaCherra). My ZIP code is 11222. My affiliation is the Coalition to Stop the North Brooklyn Pipeline. I live in Greenpoint. Can you hear me?

(John): Yes, (Kevin), go ahead.

(Kevin LaCherra): Great, so one quick thing. This was not intended to be a question but, sir, you had just mentioned that at New Town Creek, that the scrubbers were in. And they're putting that - they're putting the burn off back into the system which would be news to me. For the past two years, the community has been begging for it. National Grid has been, you know, not all that responsive and we had heard back at the community board meeting in January that all of a sudden, when 60 people are in a room with the National Grid reps, that all of a sudden it was about to happen. But I had not heard that it had happened. So I don't know if that's accurate or not.

But that's not my question about the presentation obviously, but it would be news to me because I do a lot of work on New Town Creek and so do plenty of other people that are on this call. So, you know, I know that gas powers the plants, but the 5,000 homes if that energy is coming back into the system, I had seen no announcement about it. I had not heard anything about it from the groups that do advocacy up there. You know, so is that accurate?

(John): So again, if that's your question, that's fine. (McKenzie), I believe (McKenzie) can answer that question and let's start with (McKenzie).

(McKenzie): Yes, happy to answer that question. So the biogas recovery facility at New Town Creek has been under construction for actually over a year now I believe. So it's well underway. There's equipment in place. The gas scrubbers are in place. We are still working on finishing that facility and actually connecting it into the system. We're expecting that to happen sometime this in the next month or so. But construction is underway. The project is ongoing.

(John): All right, thank you. Operator?

Coordinator: And that is with (Elizabeth Adams). Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Elizabeth Adams): Hi, my name is (Elizabeth). I work for Councilmember (Stephen Levin) and my ZIP code is 11222. And my question, so the councilmember along with the public advocate too (Jumaane Williams) and a few other councilmembers as well have called for the suspension of non-essential construction. You know, during the pandemic that we are going through right now. There are a lot of needs that we have that are really pressing. And the health of our workers and the health of employees and folks in our community is of utmost concern. I think we need to make sure that we are all staying home. We're all practicing social distancing. And so, given a lot of the response for elected officials, around nonessential construction, not continuing, I'm curious about National Grid's decision to continue with this pipeline at this time when a construction worker has already tested positive for coronavirus.

And then also just from on Councilmember (Leven)'s behalf, he is - his office is not received information about construction of Phase 5 yet which would go directly through our district. So just I'm not quite sure how that is. But if you could share more information of how that got through with, but the local councilmember has not been updated on that. Thank you.

(John): All right, (Elizabeth), I think I captured them. First off, we will get back to the councilman's office with any concerns they have with respect to the Phase 5 process. Your other question was in respect to our field forces I believe with respect to social distancing and the work that is being performed. So I mean that's a great question. It's a concern we all should have. So one of the things that we've done at the onset at National Grid is we've worked with our regulator and have reduced the work to emergency work only. So in addition

to that as you probably know, from some of the press releases as well is that we've also suspended some of the work, much of the workaround cutoffs and we've also suspended late payments for bills, recognizing the, you know, the very difficult time that our customers are going through with respect to not only the pandemic, but it's impact on the economy and to their livelihoods as well.

So we've eliminated late fees. We've stopped the cutoff process. And so that does two things, right? It reduces the hardship on customers, but in addition to that, it reduces the risk with respect to not only our crews interacting with the public, but also the public from our crews. So it really benefits both sides. We've also taken that further than just disconnects. We've - a lot of the routine maintenance that's typically performed. Both downstate on our gas system, but also upstate on our electric and gas system, we've reduced much of that non or that routine or nonemergency work and we've done that in concert with our regulator. There's a lot of work especially in the gas business. That's mandated work. That's required by our regulator for us to perform all in the interest of public safety.

So when you think about, you know, whether there's a gas leak or a need for a cutoff that somebody needs heat or hot water or cooking, we still need to perform those functions. And as much as try to maintain social distancing with our crews, we've given them and outfitted them with a series of questions and also personal protective gear to minimize the exposure both ways from our employees to customers and also from customers and employees. So we reviewed all of that information with our field employees. At some locations you may see multiple vehicles because now we're having those crews which, you know, two weeks ago would have gotten to the Jobsite in one truck. They're going with the truck they need plus their own personal car, again, to increase or to take advantage of social distancing benefits.

So a lot going on in that space and again, that work that's going on at this point has been considered to be emergency type of work. Not only emergency for today but things are emergency that you're actually in construction with. So more to come on that and we'll continue to communicate that through various press releases. So thank you very much for that question and we'll make sure that we follow up with the councilman's office.

Coordinator: Thank you, and this does conclude the question and answer session.

(John): All right, so again, that concludes our Q&A, but I think a lot of on the previous calls we've seen a lot of interest in the public comment section. So we want to make sure that we certainly have the time to do that. This session will go through 9:00 p.m. and we'll begin with a public oral comment period and then allow you to present your public statement on the options or the report or any other item that you have. Our listening panel will include myself. (Cameron) is also on the line who is the executive who prepared the report. And (Melanie Litteljohn). (Melanie) is our executive for our New York State customer and community management organization. Tonight (Melanie Littlejohn) will be facilitating the public comments section. So (Melanie), are you on?

(Melanie Littlejohn): Good, hi. Good evening all. And thank you (John) and thank all of you. Please note that this section, the public comment period session is limited to your statements. We will not be taking questions at this point. Because the Q&A portion of the program is closed.

Now to get us started once you get into queue, to get into queue, please dial Star 1. Once the operator opens your line and you come on the line, please

gain, state your name, your ZIP code and affiliation for the record and then certainly you can begin your statement.

We'll be limiting all comments to two minutes. Each comment will be recorded and transcribed and submitted unabridged to the New York State PFC. Now if you believe you need more time to expand on your statement or certainly if you have further questions, we encourage you to visit our Web site at Ngrid.com\longtermsolutions. And there you can upload a written statement or you can provide any or ask any other questions directly as well to the public service commission.

Again, as a reminder, please dial Star 1 to make your comment and operator, I ask for the first caller.

Coordinator: Thank you. The first caller is (Kevin Lachara) and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Kevin LaCherra): Hi, my name is (Kevin LaCherra). Again, from Greenpoint. My ZIP code is 11222. And my affiliation is the Coalition to Step North Brooklyn Pipeline. I didn't get to ask my actual question, Mr. (Bruckner) went ahead and cut me off there. But I have deep concerns in our community. I'm a Type 1 diabetic. I've been sheltering at home for 12 days. Many of the people on this call are sheltering in their homes to protect their neighbors, to protect their neighborhoods. In fact, Mr. (Bruckner) himself said that it's in all our best interest not to be gathering in one place from a public health perspective. That's why we have had to go through this very difficult process of getting online and 30% of this borough does not have access to the internet.

And so, you know, that's, who are we leaving out? Meanwhile there are workers in the street finishing up Phase 4 and moving onto Phase 5 regardless

of the fact that they don't have permission to do so. Phase 4 stops and Montrose and Manhattan and workers are currently working as of this afternoon on Waterbury Street. The street is closed. It's shutdown. Though they don't have permission from the Public Service Commission to do that. They're taking advantage of this human catastrophe that our entire city is facing unprecedented to make another dollar or two for their shareholders and it's absolutely criminal.

Our representatives from State Senate and Assembly from Council from the Public Advocates Office have called on them to stop. You know, and I don't know why they haven't stopped. Their workers are in danger and they're putting the neighborhoods that they're working in danger. It's impossible to believe that all these plans that they've put out would do what's best for our communities in the future because we are in the middle of a global pandemic. We're in the middle of an emergency right now and National Grid refuses to do it right now.

You know, there is going to be a reckoning when all this is done. You know, and what we need is public power. We don't need National Grid. We don't need Con Ed. We don't need these plans that they have. We can rely on each other.

(Melanie Littlejohn): Thank you. Thank you, (Kevin). Operator, next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Rachael). Your line is open and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Rachael): Hi, I'm (Rachael). I'm a Brooklyn resident and my ZIP code is 11231. Can I go ahead?

(Melanie Littlejohn): Yes, please.

(Rachael): Okay, so I'm environmentally friendly and I'm a clean energy supporter, but I'm also a realist about how we're going to meet our energy needs right now. And we're simply not ready on renewable energy. First, I wanted to dispel the notion that we can just reduce energy usage to solve our problems. If we try that, we're just going to push as many people toward heating oil which, you know, everyone knows is dirty and expensive.

A demand response system sounds nice in theory but it sounds like people will end up with their service shut off at the worst times and they'll use up using oil then too. Weatherization can probably save some energy, but people just don't have the money right now to invest in it especially in this economy given what's going on right now. And the report says that's going to take until 2035 anyway. So I think New York should move forward on the NESE project now. Get the energy people need and can afford now and get away from heating oil. That's the end of my comment.

(Melanie Littlejohn): Good, thank you. Thank you (Rachael). can we have the next call, please?

Coordinator: Yes, up next is (Eric Radezky). Please state your affiliation and your ZIP code.

(Eric Radezky): Hi, this is (Eric Radezky) from Assemblyman (Joe Lentol)'s office, ZIP code 11222. And I just want to reiterate the points that a couple of people have already mentioned. That right now is not the time to be pushing forward with the construction of the MRI pipeline and the project really ought to be put on pause like the rest of the state has been at least until the coronavirus pandemic comes under control in our community and we have a real chance to look at this not just on a phone call with a web presentation, but live in-person

meetings that foster, you know, real give and take and real debate from the public. Thank you. That's all I have to say.

(Melanie Littlejohn): Thank you, (Eric). Operator, next call, please.

Coordinator: Up next is (Bridget Kaplinski). Your line is open and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Bridget Kaplinski): Hi, it's (Bridge Kaplinski), 11683. I'm representing the Rockaway Beach Civic Association and I just wanted to offer that the Rockaway Beach Civic voted overwhelmingly against the NESE Williams pipeline and as presented in overview, these new and additional options are just as dirty, dangerous and disruptive to a frontline community like the Rockaway and just as damaging to our livelihoods, our ecosystems, and our coastal existence. The Rockaways, you know, have resoundingly said no to LNG with concerns around safety and emissions. This is not an acceptable option.

We've already experienced firsthand climate change, excuse me, through Hurricane Sandy. And it's really unfathomable that you're proposing LNG in the short term or the long term. Our future really needs renewables now. And I also just wanted to say that I agree with several of the other comments that it's unreal that National Grid is holding these hearings now in the midst of a health and economic crisis, sorry, due to the pandemic.

You know, our community is facing big challenges like a lot of other places and it's very difficult for a lot of individuals to purchase through phone or videoconference right now as they're facing such a disruption in their personal and professional lives. Yes, just in sum, I think if these options can't be presented in sort of a constructed and operated without doing such immediate harm to our frontline communities, that's a failure. And on that note, I'm just

really shocked to hear that LNG trucking barges, excuse me, or stations are even part of the conversation right now.

And, sorry, I'm losing my voice a little bit. But that's my comment and thank you for the opportunity.

(Melanie Littlejohn): Sure, thank you. Thank you, (Bridget). Next caller.

Coordinator: That is from (Matt). Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Matt Oliver): Hi, hello? Hi. This is (Matt Oliver), 11226. I'm a Brooklyn resident. First, I just want to say that I support national gas. I use it to cook and to heat my apartment and the bills are cheap and, you know, it's great. Last year when National Grid issued the moratorium, it put a real strain on development here. You know, this is really not the time to be half solving problems. We're heading into a really tough economy. You know, I remember what things were like in 2008 when everything collapsed. And I can't imagine why Grid is even considering half these options to be honest. Like the Iroquois pipeline, won't even be ready for like three years and doesn't even get New York enough gas. So some of these other things won't be ready even until like 2035.

When you said at the top of this call that we need the gas in two years, so we get it on a moratorium in the middle of that, that just doesn't make any sense to me. I support the NESE project because I don't see why New Yorkers should have to be stuck without access to gas if they want to open a business or move, especially since we have no idea what our economy's going to look like at that point. And that's the end of my comment. Thank you.

Woman 1: Good. Thank you. (Matt), next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is Wendy Holser-Hijos. Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Wendy Holser-Hijos: Hey, good evening. My name is Wendy Holser-Hijos. Pardon me. And I am the New York executive director for the Consumer Energy Alliance. And in the spirit of time I'll keep this really brief. We as an alliance are in full support of the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project because it benefits our environment, number 1. It saves money and it provides a long-term solution, and I say solution because it's very important. It's more than a benefit. It is a solution for businesses and families all across the board in our great state of New York.

And I also want to say hat's off to (John), (Cameron) and (Melanie). You're doing a fantastic job and I really appreciate all your support. Thank you.

Woman 1: Good. Thank you, Wendy. Next caller.

Coordinator: That is from (Alexandra Zevin). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Alexandra Zevin): Hi. My name is (Alexandra Zevin) and my zip code is 1123H. I'm a rate payer, a third-generation New Yorker and a retired public school teacher and a homeowner. All of the new infrastructure projects that National Grid is trying to force down rate payers' throats are an engine for global warming and a threat to biodiversity.

These New York projects contradict New York State's renewable energy goals with an aim for carbon-free sources of energy by 2050, and at this point during the pandemic, they violate Cuomo's directive that nonessential workers stay home from work during the pandemic.

I'm furious that National Grid is continuing its work on the MRI North Brooklyn pipeline during this pandemic, especially now that we know one of your construction workers in North Brooklyn has gotten sick and that you have people working without social distancing. This is a threat to the lives of workers and to all New Yorkers.

National Grid should cease construction for the North Brooklyn pipeline and all pipelines, and donate masks, goggles and safety equipment to local hospitals.

I'm speaking as a person living with leukemia who's been in the ER seven times in the past six years in addition to hospital stays, intensive care stays and urgent care visits. I'm sheltering in place right now. Everyone knows that New York hospitals are drastically underequipped and understaffed. The sick population is doubling every three days, and National Grid is engaging in business practices that put my life and the lives of my fellow New Yorkers at risk. Why? So that the CEO can make thousands of dollars an hour.

Very few working people know about this meeting, and many would not find its format accessible, which is a shame because it's working people that will be harmed most by these projects because of environmental and public health impacts. National Grid is a public menace, and I can't wait until the utility is publicly owned.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Alexandra). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is (Steve Fox). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Steve Fox): Hey there. My name is (Steve Fox). My zip code is 11206. I'm a concerned citizen, energy policy expert and National Grid rate payer. I will first off commend you for using technology and holding these meetings digitally. However, the system did not recognize my request to ask a question. In fact, 30% of people who live in Brooklyn have no access to the Internet whatsoever. And 17% do not have access to a computer at home.

So their questions also were not recognized. For assistance (unintelligible) its dependence on Web access. This clearly is not a public input session. You're ignoring the voices of our most vulnerable populations and by no means have you fulfilled the duties to give public input for your agreement of PSE. Thank you.

Woman 1: Good. Thank you. (Matthew), next caller.

Coordinator: And that is from (Joe Brown). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Joe Brown): (Joe Brown), (Shale Directories). I support the Energy NESE Project because it helps many of the people described on the call that have - don't have Internet excess and are low income. Natural gas is by far the cheapest, best way to provide information and warmth throughout the year, and it's the best solution as we recover from the pandemic. Thank you.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Joe). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That's (Ed Power). Please state your affiliation and zip code, please.

(Ed Power): Zip code 11697 and rate payer. Let's remember how we got to this point. It was the lies of National Grid trying to force the pipeline through. So now we

are supposed to take at face value these propositions that you're recommending when in reality you are only concerned with the pipeline.

At the Rockaway resident, you know, I know you're not taking questions, but if you were, I would ask you if you have money set aside for a - any cancer clusters that may occur due to this swimmers such as myself and thousands of us who use the Atlanta Ocean. I suspect that you don't.

Also as a New York City chief, fire department, as a first responder who worked during Sandy in Rockaway, I witnessed - I saw people die. And it was partially attributable to pipelines that you are proposing to put in. So I am against this. And think about what you're doing. Thank you very much.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Joe). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Alvin). Your line is open, and please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Alvin Pena): Hi. This is (Alvin Pena) calling from Senator Julia Salazar's office, zip code 11211. I'm calling to state that the senator is vehemently against anymore fossil fuel infrastructure building. The - and to be putting people, you know, profits before people in this sense when we're asking for social distancing to put people not in priority and the public not in priority, when it comes to continuing work is concerning.

You know, we know that putting just one person or just a few people in a community exposed could further and further and multiple, so, you know, we're asking for a reconsideration and for National Grid to not put anymore nonessential work on the front burner and perhaps put it on the backburner for - until this state of emergency is lifted. That's it.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Alvin). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: I have no one in queue at this point.

Woman 1: So while we are waiting for others to come in queue, a couple of other things that I did want to just clarify for a couple of our - a couple of the callers tonight certainly that you can find full transcripts from our March 9 meeting, our in-person meeting that we held out in Hicksville. Those - that full transcript is available as of now on our Web site and certainly will be provided to the (PSC) as well.

One of our other callers this evening indicated providing access and access to all customers as a part of our bill and search and the information that we provided to customers leading up to the series of meetings. We ask that folks who wanted to write a letter and a letter to the (PSC) certainly providing the information to allow them to do so. So that's just a couple of clarifying points in terms of providing or making comments.

Let me pause there and to see whether or not we have any additional callers waiting to provide comments.

Coordinator: We do have some callers. First up is Elizabeth Adams. Please state your affiliation and your zip code.

Elizabeth Adams: Hi. My name is Elizabeth Adams. I work for Council Member Stephen Levin. And my zip code is 11222. And first, just to say, just in response to National Grid's remarks are referenced to my question earlier. I just want to clarify for the record that building the MRI Pipeline is certainly not emergency construction. I think saying that is pretty disingenuous.

It's not responding to heat needs that people have or fixing pipes so that people can have access to heat that's shut off. It's solely about new infrastructure. So I just want to clarify that it's not an emergency response and I don't think that we should advertise it as such.

And then also just to add for the record to state the council members' opposition to the MRI Pipeline overall, you know, we know we need to get off of fossil fuel energy. We need to be putting our focus and our energy into renewable energy into thermal and that is where - what needs to be the focus of our work, not spending money that frankly we don't have at the state to - and that our - for our rate payers to have to bear this burden for new infrastructure for gas pipelines.

So now it's certainly not the time. I think more than ever we need to be thinking about how we're thinking about the wellbeing of our communities and the wellbeing of our futures and our future communities. And if anything, this pandemic should really be a wake up call for how we're taking care of our community's health and wellbeing, and that is certainly not fossil fuel energy that is moving to green energy and a greener future for all of us. Thank you.

Woman 1: Thank you, Elizabeth. Next caller?

Coordinator: Thank you. Up next is (Elodi). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Elodi): Hi. My name is (Elodi). I live in Brooklyn. My zip code is 11236. So I just want to say I support Northeast Supply Enhancement. Iroquois is obviously not even a solution. It only brings a tiny fraction of the gas New York needs anyway. And it really just seems like a band aid to a huge problem I consider to be really important. I'm interested in energy efficient options, but they

seem really expensive, and from the information that you guys provided, they won't be ready for 15 years anyway. So I don't even know why you guys are listing it as a solution.

I hope you all make this decision knowing that keeping the residents and the businesses in mind since we are the ones that are greatly affected by this, the Northeast Supply Enhancement is the one that will get us the gas we need in time. Thank you. Have a nice day.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Elodi). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Mike). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Mike): Hi. My name is (Mike). I'm an Upstate resident, 13045. I'm a National Grid customer. You all are worried about your precious little environment down there. Why don't you come up to Upstate New York and see what your solar farms are doing to these farms up here. Hundreds and hundreds of acres are being plastered with the most ugly, useless solar farms that you've ever seen in your life.

There's nobody going to be owning these things in a few years. NESE is obviously a better choice. It's a good choice now. Pennsylvania has more gas than they can possibly produce and use, and why not use it now until we find the right solution because what you're doing up here is not the right solution. Thank you.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Mike). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is with a person from the Food and Water Action. Please state your name and your zip code.

(Laura Shindell): This is (Laura Shindell), Food and Water Action, zip code 10019. Earlier in tonight's call, you said that you would find out how many people were on last night's call and tonight's call. I just wanted to remind folks we're still waiting on those answers.

I also wanted to mention that I know at least three people who said that they were on the queue last night and you closed out the meeting last night saying the queue was empty. We did go over time ending the meeting at 9:10, but National Grid could have just said that rather than lying to the public and misrepresenting how many people are on the call and who knows how many other people had been waiting that did not have a chance to speak last night.

Furthermore, we did get several emails of folks who wanted to join the virtual meeting, but when prompted to download an extension for this format you're using, they chose not to. They were wary of having to download something onto their computer for good reason. There's formats like Zoom that don't require a download but rather just clicking a link, and also settings that would make this more transparent, allowing us to see the other people in the meeting.

So I'd like to just ask that these meetings, the next four - three that take place are improved to make them open and transparent like the Public Service Commission and Governor Cuomo mandated you to make them. Furthermore, fracked gas is destroying Pennsylvania and it's illegal to do here because of its impact on water.

And so it's incomprehensible to be increasing reliance on fracked gas in New York State. It's not a bridge fuel. It keeps the atmosphere 86 times more

effectively than carbon dioxide over a 20-year period. So building infrastructure just brings us further into the climate crisis. Thank you.

Woman 1: Thank you for your comments, (Laura). So a couple of quick things, as promised. Last night there were 350 attendees on the call last night, and this evening we have 140 attendees. And one of the things we do want to note that customers or listeners or callers do not have to download. They just need to click on the meeting link. So thank you. Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Noelle Picone). Your line is open. And please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Noelle Picone): (Surfrider NYC Chapter), zip code is Brooklyn 11201. So like so many others, I want to open with how appalled I am at both National Grid and the (PSC) for proceeding with these meetings during the height of a public health crisis.

The fact that you made the meeting virtual does not solve the public participation issue. Many people are too ill or distracted to participate in a meeting in any format. People are worried about the health of their loved ones, when they are getting their next paycheck or how to get groceries. Shame on National Grid for moving forward with these meetings, and also shame on the (PSC), which is supposed to be monitoring this process and ensuring compliance of the fulfillment order, for permitting them to do so. The public will not forget about this.

Turning to your long-term options, you know and we know that we are here for only one option and that is NESE) pipeline. You were ordered to hold these meetings because you issued a self-imposed moratorium, and the reason why you issued that moratorium is because the DEC denied NESE last May.

You have contracted with Williams for this almost $1 billion project and it is the entire reason we are all here. Everything else is no more than a charade.

The DEC denied NESE for several reasons, including that it would result in the release of toxins such as mercury and lead into New York Harbor, destroy any benthic community in its path and heighten climate change. Yet, in your Long-Term Capacity Report, you state that the community impacts of NESE would be minimal. That's your word, minimal, because the majority of the construction is happening offshore.

Mr. Bruckner or any other National Grid employee on this call, I would like you to meet with the resident of Rockaway or Coney Island or Staten Island and look them in the eye and tell them that this pipeline will not impact their community. Super storms like Sandy, which destroyed New York City's coastal communities in 2012, are a result of climate change. That is science.

As the DEC has concluded, this pipeline will continue towards climate change. The benthic communities are natural storm barriers that help protect the coast from surge. As the DEC concluded, this pipeline would destroy the benthic communities in its path. The ocean is a backyard to coastal communities and is...

Woman 1: (Noelle), thank you. Thank you so much.

(Noelle Picone): If you could just give me three more seconds. There is not a lot of people in line. Many more New Yorkers who swim, surf and fish in it. As the DEC concluded, the pipeline will release toxins into the ocean. We live here. I don't know where you live, but do you want your children swimming in toxins? I don't think so.

Woman 1: (Noelle), thank you so much...

(Noelle Picone): So the fact that you say...

Woman 1: ...for your feedback. We certainly want to give and allow other customers to have their voice and their comments to be a part of the process, and again, what I encourage you to do is please, if there are additional items you want to add to your statement, we encourage you to go to our Web site which you can continue to provide your comments there. And again, those are your comments. They will be listed there as well as you have the opportunity as well to provide them to the (PSC). Thank you. We appreciate it. Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is (Alice). If you could please state your affiliation and your zip code.

(Alex): Hi. My name's (Alex). My zip code's 11203. I just wanted to say that I think we really need to be aware of the emissions some of these options are going to cause. This Iroquois plan, it doesn't look like it's going to meet demand, leaving people on their own and probably buying - needing oil. The demand response concept actually requires homeowners to have alternative fuel sources available, which will almost definitely be heating oil. And trucking and gas causes a huge amount of emissions from vehicle delivery. Those emissions will be right in our neighborhood.

This liquified natural gas plan might be adding even more greenhouse gas emissions out of all the natural gas options. Right now I'm scared, my neighbors are scared. I think this pandemic crisis is even more of a reason to support an option that's reliable. We, our communities, we have energy needs, and that's a fact. Infrastructure projects are necessary, especially now,

and workers depend on these projects for income. These are not people who make thousands of dollars an hour.

NESE seems like the cleanest and most realistic route from an environmental perspective. I'm supporting the NESE project and I'm really hoping you approve it. Also, I'm personally speaking on a phone right now, which I believe a significant number of New Yorkers have access to.

Woman 1: Good. Thank you, (Alice). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Paro). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and your zip code.

(Tara): Is that me?

Coordinator: I do believe it's (Paro) or (Pharo). I'm sorry. I could not understand the recording. I apologize. You stated that you were a Brooklyn resident?

(Tara): Yes. Sorry. I can't tell if that's me. Yes.

Coordinator: Yes, go ahead, please.

(Tara): Okay. Thank you. Sorry. My name is (Tara), and I'm a Brooklyn resident. My zip code is 11205. First, I want to say that the trucking gas option should be removed from the list. I don't want 100 more trucks idling and driving through our neighborhoods. We have too much of that as it is. There are a number of other things you laid out in this meeting that would never happen like all of the LNG proposals that have been tried and rejected. I don't see any other options besides the NESE project actually solving this problem now.

With everything going on in the world, our government should be pragmatic in its approach to these big questions and should be thinking about the impact all these issues have on regular people. Thank you.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Tara). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Steve Fox). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and a zip code.

(Steve Fox): Hi there. My name is (Steve Fox). My zip code is 11206. My affiliation is that I'm a local resident, concerned citizen and a rate payer for National Grid. I know that someone, I believe her name was (Noelle Picone) speaking from (unintelligible) earlier, was cut off. I'd like to seed my time to her.

Woman 1: (Noelle), are you there?

Coordinator: One moment, and I - thank you. One moment. I will open her line. She has disconnected from the call.

Woman 1: Okay. Thank you. And thank you, (Steve), for sharing your time. Next caller, please.

Coordinator: I have no one in queue at this moment.

Woman 1: We will keep the lines open in anticipation of additional callers.

Coordinator: Thank you. I do have (Noelle) back online. And your line is open.

(Noelle Picone): Hi. Thank you. And thank you, (Steve), for giving me your time. You know, it's 7:51 and this doesn't end until 9:00. And, you know, getting back to the

due process complaints that we all have been making, the fact that you cut me off with no one in queue or very few people with an hour and ten minutes left is - goes to that. It goes to the problem that the public has right now with this process.

So I don't know where you cut me off. I have no idea, but what I was trying to say at the very end was the DEC has concluded that this proposed NESE project will be devastating to coastal communities. That's their entire decision. They only can look at environmental impacts, and that's what they did. And so for you to say in your proposal that this pipeline is not going to have an impact on coastal communities is just, makes me nauseous.

And what I wanted to end with was, you know, the ocean is - the backyard of the coastal community is like Rockaway and Coney Island and Staten Island. It's why people live there. And I don't know where you live, but we all live here. We're New Yorkers. That's who's calling in tonight. You know, do you want your children swimming in toxins? The DEC concluded and confirmed that this pipeline will definitely release mercury and lead into the ocean, into our ocean that we're fighting to preserve.

So the fact that you have the audacity to state that NESE will have minimal impacts on communities. And then, by the way, your expert, quote-unquote, "expert" reiterated that last night on the call, so you don't just have it in writing in your report but your expert actually said that when it was questioned. It's not only false and misleading, but it's insulting and dismissive. And New Yorkers have already said no to NESE and we're saying it again tonight. So please take it off the table.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Noelle). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That comes from (Jake) -- I'm sorry, my apologies -- (JK Canepa). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(JK Canepa): Thank you. My name is (JK Canepa), Sane Energy Project, zip code 10009. And I'd like to build on this comment by (Noelle Picone), Surfrider. In 1970, the waters off of the coast of the Rockaways and Staten Island by considered by Woods Hole Oceanographic Institute to be the most grossly polluted waters offshore in the entire United States.

The pollution was PCB, DDTs, lead, zinc, mercury, copper, organics and everything else that you can name. The ocean was used as a toilet. There were 20 square miles of a dead zone with nothing alive in it, no oxygen at all to support any life. This is what is buried under that pathway, the right of way that the Williams Pipeline would take 23 miles from the Raritan Bay to the juncture of the Rockaway Lateral is loaded underneath the surface of the sea with buried the worst grossly polluted elements and chemicals off the Coast of the United States everywhere.

So when one claims that there would be no environmental impact, contrary to what the DEC said twice is it - how are you going to address the discharge of specifically mercury and copper into your waters? That is counter intuitive. I don't see how National Grid has any sense that this would not have an environmental impact, not just on the people but on the marine community and on the fishing community and on the web of life and the food chain that comes from the benthic organisms that live on that sea floor that would be totally decimated and completely wiped out.

Williams' solution to that is to support some clamming community out further on Long Island, which would not address our problem at all. Thank you very much.

Woman 1: Good. Thank you. Next caller, please.

Coordinator: I have no one in the queue at this time. And as a reminder it is star 1 if you would like to have a comment, and please record your name. Thank you.

Woman 1: We will continue to leave the line open waiting for other callers.

Coordinator: I do have a caller, and that is (Katherine Thompson). Your line is open. And please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Katherine Thompson): I'm in zip code 11222 in Green Point, Brooklyn. I'm affiliated with Coalition to Stop the North Brooklyn Pipeline. I'm very concerned about the climate emergency. I'm worried about the future of our children and of our planet, and I'm fully against any expansion and construction of new fossil fuel infrastructure. This is the time we have to pivot away from gas and all of this frack gas pipeline and go into renewable energy.

In your presentation you talked a lot about the non-infrastructure options. It seemed like there was tons of contracting, supplier jobs. There are jobs that need - people could be trained for. It seemed like an - there's a lot to do in this area. And I think the investment should be there.

And the rate should not be raised with all the customers so that it will be paying for the fossil fuel infrastructure. It needs to pay for renewable energy and different kinds of investments. And we have to do this because we're in a climate emergency. The city said it, the state said it. The globe is protesting. Nature is challenging us every day, and we have to listen to her. Thank you.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Karen). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: I have no callers in the queue right now. And as a reminder, it is star 1 if you would like to have your line open for a statement. Please record your name in order to be introduced. Thank you. And I do have a party. That is from (Ed Power). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code, please.

(Ed Power): Zip code 11697. And a rate payer. I just - for some of the one or two people who touted how good Pennsylvania was doing, let's - I just want to let - I'm sure that National Grid knows this, but what we're doing when we're fracking is we're taking the organic matter (unintelligible) that's encapsulated within the earth and we're releasing it with its radioactivity and that's the - what we're doing is now subjecting our atmosphere to all of that methane, which for some reason people still think is - it's a clean fuel just because it doesn't burn as dirty as coal. However, it is much worse than CO2, 86 times.

So I'd like people to understand how toxic the whole system is from contamination of the workers, the radioactivity, to the generating stations and all the poor people who live around there, the ozone - excuse me, the radon, it's just inconceivable that in this country we would still be doing this when it's the worst possible thing we can do for our planet.

Now I know people are making money off of this. That's why it's done. There has to be a better way. And thank you for listening to me.

Woman 1: Thank you. Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Katherine Thompson). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code, please.

(Katherine Thompson): I'm calling from Green Point, Brooklyn, 11222. I'm affiliated with the Coalition to Stop the North Brooklyn Pipeline. I wanted to point out that the way that National Grid makes money is by having contracts to build infrastructure. So that is why they need to raise the rates for everybody to pay for these pipelines where, you know, infrastructure can be of many things.

It doesn't have to be a frack gas pipeline. It doesn't have to be fossil fuel transmission, and as a citizen, as a rate payer, as a part of the public, I don't feel that this is for the public good. I know it's for the profits of National Grid and their shareholders, and I resent that we are endangering the future of our planet and our children's future and the ecosystems that exist to pay for this right now.

Investing in the infrastructure will just promote the frack gas to be transmitted. We have to pivot away from this. We have to change the course of fossil fuel investments. Thank you.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Katherine). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Mike). Your line is open. And please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Michael Fleishman): My name is (Michael Fleishman). I have no affiliation or anything (unintelligible) and zip code 10002. I've grown increasingly concerned with our reliance on fossil fuels and our continuance of spending money on fossil fuel projects when, in fact, renewable energy seems to be unequivocally the way we need to be spending money, especially any money that is involved in rate payers National Grid (unintelligible) plans for this pipeline. And we renewables now.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Mike). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: I have no one in queue at this time. And as a reminder, it is star 1 if you would like to have your line open. And please record your name in order to be introduced. Thank you.

Man 1: (Melanie), can we give another reminder on the Web site and where they can - where any comments can also be sent?

(Melanie Littlejohn): Sure. Please get your comments. You can provide your comments on our Web site at ngrid.com/longtermsolutions, and you have the opportunity to upload a written statement, or if there are additional questions you can log them there as well and certainly all of this information you can also provide to the New York State Public Service Commission.

Coordinator: And I do have a caller. I have (Joan Flynn). Your line is open. If you would please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Joan Flynn): My name is (Joan Flynn). I am a member of Rockaway Women for Progress. I am also a member of Surfrider. I have been sitting here trying to eat my dinner, listening to all of this, and the idea that you have the nerve to say long-term solutions are your Web site is totally unacceptable. I know that we have gone through so much on the Rockaway Peninsula. And we will not accept a pipeline.

My question to all of the National Grid people is how do you sleep at night? How do you look at your children? How do you look at your grandchildren and think, "Yes, I'm doing the right thing." Long-term solutions? I don't think so.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Joan). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: I have no callers in queue at this point. And as a reminder, it is star 1 if you would like to have you line open. And please record your name in order to be introduced. Thank you.

Woman 1: Also as a reminder, full transcripts from our March 9 meeting is on our Web site and is there for review as well, and that same transcript will be provided tot the (PSC) as well. And of course if you know of other customers who might not have access to Internet, please certainly feel free to share that they can write a letter to the (PSC) and that information as well has been provided as part of the (unintelligible) information. So thank you.

Any other callers available?

Coordinator: I do have some callers. (Kevin LaCherra), your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Kevin LaCherra): Hi. (Kevin LaCherra). Again, C-H-E-R-R-A. And my affiliation is I'm a member of the Stop the North Brooklyn Pipeline Coalition. My zip code is 11222. And yes, I just wanted to run down the list to highlight how broad and how deep the opposition to the North Brooklyn Pipeline is in this community. And, you know, right now most of these people are stuck in their homes. We can't be in the street. But that we oppose the pipeline and want it shut down.

Sane Energy, 350 Brooklyn, Food and Water Action, Sunrise Movement, Extinction Rebellion, Communities Rise and Resist, Surfrider, the North Brooklyn DSA, New York Communities for Change, the District 14 Green Alliance which represents all of the PTAs within district - School District 14,

North Brooklyn Neighbors, El Puente, The St. Nick Alliance, Sustainable Williamsburg, the North Brooklyn Progressive Democrats.

All of Brooklyn Community Ward 1 our Comptroller (Scott Stringer), our public advocate Jumaane Williams, our state senator Julia Salazar, our assembly person Joe Lentol, our assembly person Maritza Davila, our Congresswoman Carolyn Maloney, our Congresswoman Nydia Velazquez, our Councilmember Stephen Levin, our Councilmember Antonio Reynoso, our district leader of Assembly District 53 Tommy Torres and our district leader of Assembly District 50 Nick Rizzo.

All of these people have signed on and been in the fight within North Brooklyn to stop this pipeline. And what's unbelievable is that National Grid in the middle of a global pandemic has somehow thought it appropriate to continue. They're putting the people that live here in danger with their pipeline for the long-term and for the short term they're putting their workers in danger and they're putting us in danger in the middle of a global pandemic. We need public power now.

Woman 1: Thank you, (Kevin). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Sandy Spencer). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Sandy Spencer): Thank you. Yes, name is (Sandy), and I'm just a citizen listening in to this call. My zip code is 17756. And the global pandemic has been mentioned several times. At this point our renewables, solar and wind, allow us about 20% of our energy. And I am just very concerned. I also do care about the environment, but if our hospitals only have electric 20% of the time at a time like this. If all of the different things that they need to treat these patients

were not available because of all of the tools, all of the materials that are needed to treat these people were not available because of not using any kind of fossil fuels. I wonder if people have thought about where we would be at this point. I do really support the NESE pipeline. And I believe it is the quickest and the most reliable, and also the safest option there is. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Sandy). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: I have no callers in the queue. And as a reminder, it is star one if you would like to have your line open and please record your name in order to be introduced with your question, or comment. I'm sorry, your comment.

Melanie Littlejohn: Again, as a reminder, we encourage you to visit our Web site at Ingrid.com\longtermsolutions to upload a written statement or to provide any questions. And that, in summation as well will be provided to the Public Service Commission.

Coordinator: And I do have a couple parties. The first is (Shae). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Shae): Hi, my name is (Shae). I'm a Hoboken resident. The zip code is 07030. I mean, from everything that I've heard here tonight (unintelligible) just seems like it's not even an option. The same idea that keeps getting rejected, the plan blows through the National Grid timeline for needing a solution. And it would need permitting for multiple states and federal government. I just don't see that happening anytime soon. Also, the Iroquois pipeline isn't even going to bring enough gas to get close to the supply and demand gap.

To me, really, the NESE project is the only option that's realistic and will get the gas that we need soon. So, I'm supporting the NESE project. Thanks.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Shae). Next caller please.

Coordinator: It is from (Kevin LaCherra). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Kevin): Thank you, Green point Brooklyn, 11222. Fourth time's a charm on the last name, I appreciate it. Yes, I guess I just - like the gentlemen from the Rockaways had said about these folks that are calling in for the NESE pipeline. You know, this person that just spoke that said they were from Hoboken is the first person that's identified what neighborhood they're actually living in.

And it's interesting for me as someone from Greenpoint, as someone who is deeply organized with my neighbors in Williamsburg, north, south and east Williamsburg. You know that there is very little support for this within our community, if any, you know. And the - when National Grid came to our community board meeting they had claimed they had done extensive canvassing throughout the neighborhood which was a joke - about their pipeline.

It was a joke. You know so, there's people calling from upstate, or Brooklyn generally, or New Jersey. You know, where these pipelines are actually being sighted. I'd be interested to hear from people who are living in the communities where these pipelines are actually being sighted because the people that are calling in to oppose these pipelines are the ones that are living in these communities and maybe we should be thinking about that a little bit as we move forward.

I live in Greenpoint, which is no stranger to this sort of thing. You know, we have one of the largest terrestrial oil spills in North America. It's a Superfund site. And the pollution of which on the creek here, which has been so thoroughly been destroyed by pollution - the last 100 years of pollution. The National Grid is actually one of the potentially responsible parties as identified by the federal government in the lawsuits to clean it up.

You know, and one of the reasons why they came up here in the first place was because they ran out of room in Gowanus after so thoroughly destroying the environment down there. So, we know damn well what these plans look like because we lived them. You know, we see them in the cancer clusters, we see them in the air, we see them in the water. And so, we have to oppose this. We have to stop it now.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Kevin). Next caller please.

Coordinator: One moment, please. Up next is (Julius Marx). Your line is open. And please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Julius): Hi, yes my name is (Julius Marx). I'm affiliated, I'm a Nassau resident. I believed that tonight was a Nassau hearing and this gentleman, Kevin continues to call in. I believe that's four or five times now. And, you know, my question for (Kevin) is, you know, is he just calling in to talk about Nassau, you know? He's a Brooklyn resident and he says, you know, only people that are residents should be calling in.

I just - I don't really understand what (Kevin's) issue is and why he continues to call so many times. I'll hang up and wait for (Kevin's) reply. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Julius). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: I have no parties in queue at this time. And as a reminder, it is star one if you would like to have your line opened. Please record your name in order to be introduced. And I do have (Kevin LaCherra) online. Your line is open.

Kevin: Hi, I didn't realize it was going to be like a radio call in show. I'd be happy to respond to (Julius). Tonight, my understanding - and it seems from the presentations at the beginning of this, were about National Grid's general plan statewide, particularly in areas around the city deliver fracked gas. And, you know, I don't know exactly what's happening out in Nassau County.

I know this meeting tonight wasn't exclusively pronounced by county. And the situation we're facing here in north Brooklyn right now is that National Grid is trying to put a 30 inch frack gas pipeline in the ground. They've run it through our community, through all of Brooklyn, first through communities of color via segmentation. Tonight I'm actually hearing - I'm seeing that tonight was actually Brooklyn. If we were not all trapped in our homes, this would have been at Borough Hall in downtown Brooklyn. So, you would have been taking the train in, (Julius).

But, you know, I'm calling and I'm deeply concerned about this because it's happening in my back yard. It's happening in my home. I have relatives, my entire family has a history of thyroid disorders and, you know, strange cancers that people have passed away from. And that is the story here in Greenpoint, for so many people.

You know, and so, currently, in the middle of a pandemic they have not stopped construction on a massive pipeline. They're putting their workers in danger. They're putting the people that live in these communities in danger in the short term as well as in the long term.

You know, I've called in a number of times because we're limited to two minutes of time on the clock and it seemed like there was still room in the queue until nine o'clock. And we want to have our voices heard on the record so there can be no question that north Brooklyn and all of New York City oppose this national grid and the things that they want to do because they're not helping our communities. You know, and so, all the best to you out of Nassau, (Julius) and I hope that you're well in the middle of all this craziness.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Kevin). Next caller please.

Coordinator: That is from (Steve Fox). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Steve Fox): Steve Fox, zip code is 11206. Affiliation is I live Brooklyn, so why do I have to be an affiliation? I'm a resident. I just want to state my firm opposition to the NESE pipeline. I also want to state my firm opposition to the pipeline in north Brooklyn that's currently being dug across my back yard. And I'd like to state, for the record, that the only kinds of infrastructure that I support are non-infrastructure solutions. I believe we need to reduce our need to build infrastructure that is new. Mostly because all of those will become stranded assets and I as a rate do not want to pay for them. I also, for the record, oppose - propose increase in rights. I do not want to pay for increased infrastructure. I would refer to page four efficiency. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Steven). Next caller please.

Coordinator: And the next caller is (Alisa Dorn). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Alisa Dorn): Hello, my name is (Alissa Dorn). My zip code is 11693. I'm a rate payer and a community activist and I'm calling to oppose the William's pipeline. Looking through National Grid's new report, as a rate payer, you can see how it is grossly inflated the demand projections. And we are already paying the highest - some of the highest rates in the entire nation.

And I don't think we need this. I have not seen anything to show that we need this. And otherwise, the construction of the pipeline would churn up toxins like Mercury, Arsenic, lead and PCP and threaten sea life and beach goers. And the Rockaway Beach community is against it. Thank you very much.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Alisa). Next caller, please.

Coordinator: That is from (Laura Shindell). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Laura Shindell): Hi, there. I'm with Food and Water Action. My zip code is 10019 and would just like to comment for the record an observation that many of the callers that spoke in support of the NESE Pipeline seem to reference pretty identical talking points, which is all well and good.

But, all of them said they had no affiliation and those identical talking points of first sighting, that the LNG proposal is unrealistic, and then pivoting to the Iroquois expansion which is just one of many. But, every single caller seems to be referencing it, seems to indicate that they're reading off of some talking points, but not being totally honest about that when they call in saying they have no affiliation. So, I just wanted to put that on the record. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay, thank you, (Laura). Next caller please.

Coordinator: I have no callers in the queue. And as a reminder it is star one if you would like to have your line opened. And please record your name in order to be introduced. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: As a reminder, if you would like to expand your statement, or to ask additional questions, we would encourage you to go to our Web site Ingrid.com/longtermsolutions. And you can upload a written statement, or any other questions and it will also be provided directly to the New York State Public Service Commission.

As an additional reminder, the full transcript from our March 9 meeting is available on our Web site. And subsequently, all transcripts from these calls will also be available on that same Web site. Any new callers?

Coordinator: I do have the next caller and that is (Kevin LaCherra). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Kevin LaCherra): Greenpoint Brooklyn, again. And I'm just going to say last one thing which I realize I didn't say in any of my other statements. Sorry, 11222. I had meant to say it earlier, but I'll say it now and then I'm probably going to get off the call.

Just that Greenpoint and all of north Brooklyn stands with our neighbors in the Rockaways and any neighborhood that is fighting a moral fossil fuel and infrastructure. The goal of which is profit for shareholders and the consequences of which is the destruction of the planet. They make our neighborhoods and the places we live more dangerous. They threaten the lives of those who live here now and those who might live here in generations to come. They put that in jeopardy.

So often they try to do this work in communities that are forgotten communities. As far as New York City goes, they're not running these pipelines through, you know, Park Slope. They're not running these pipelines through the financial district. They're running them through places like Green Point, and East Williamsburg, through Brownsville and Bushwick and East New York. They're running the through places like the Rockaways.]

They're running them through communities that are seen by National Grid as disposable. You know, and so we stand together. Greenpoint stands with you and National Grid may have, you know, may not care about you, but we do. And we stand together as New Yorkers and as Brooklyners (sic). Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Kevin). Next caller please.

Coordinator: I have no callers in the queue at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Also, we would encourage you to not only go to that Web site, Ingrid.com/longtermsolutions certainly to upload any written statement, or to provide any questions, but we also have information available about our customer assistance program that you might find helpful for both residential as well as some of our small business commercial customers. So, please go to that Web site, Ingrid.com/longtermsolutions. Any other callers in line?

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay, are there any additional callers?

Man 1: Ko Tanaka (unintelligible) Solar hello?

Melanie Littlejohn: Was someone waiting in line?

Coordinator: I am so sorry, I had my mute button on. This gentleman, your line is open. If you could please state your affiliation and zip code, your line is open.

(Ko Tanaka): Hi, I'm (Ko Tanaka) working for Kamtech Solar, 11234. I'm (unintelligible) to this pipeline issue. I'm just a concerned citizen about the environment. As we're going through this pandemic, I'm guessing the - our user projection, demand projection will be quite off because of the, you know, (unintelligible) activities. In fact, yesterday (unintelligible) Chief of Council projected 20 or 30 percent unemployment rate due to the pandemic. So, we actually looking at great (unintelligible) level of, you know, serious problem.

So, I'd like to encourage natural gas through looking through this future demand model carefully to probably, you know, you guys have to going back to drawing board. That may not require any additional pipelines, or additional capacity at all. That's all. Thank you so much, bye bye.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you. Any additional callers on the line?

Coordinator: I do have Richard Berkeley on the line. If you would state your affiliation and zip code.

(Richard Berkeley): Thank you. My name is (Richard Berkeley). I am with the Public Utility Law Project of New York. My zip code is 12210.

I wish to start by saying that - to give my thanks to the folks who have called in tonight and say that the Public Utility Law Project of New York stands with the people of Brooklyn, South Queens and Long Island in this ongoing situation with the Moratorium and the pipeline questions. I also want to thank the company for providing these opportunities. At the same time I wish to

note on several serious concerns with the way these virtual meetings are being handled.

First, I'm concerned that the company has not done enough work to popularize and spread knowledge of the meetings to people without telephones and people without internet. I was unable to see the presentation at the beginning of tonight because my internet is acting up due to its over usage during this pandemic. And there are numbers, many, many, many, tens of thousands of people, hundreds of thousands of people in New York City that neither have basic telephone service nor internet. And I question whether the company has made any attempt to bring them into the process.

I also question the fact that the transcripts of these meetings will be provided to the PSC as part of the record concerning its long term plans. And I would like not to have these call in situations that are more of a popularity contest -- pro or con -- to be part of the record in either the rate case proceeding, the investigation of the Moratorium, or new proceeding, which I'm uncertain whether National Grid announces tonight, which is into the long term planning for gas usage in the state.

On top of all those things, I wish to associate the Public Utility Law Project with opposition to the double digit rate increases in Brooklyn and in Long Island. We're very concerned about affordability. We're litigant in the rate case. We'll stay in there and we will continue to fight for the people of Brooklyn and Long Island. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you. Thank you, (Richard). Any remaining callers online?

Coordinator: Yes, I do have (Vincent Albanese). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and your zip code.

(Vincent Albanese): Yes, my name is (Vincent Albanese). I work for the New York State Laborers and work throughout the five boroughs in Long Island, representing over 40,000 workers in the state. I just want to mention one thing, or clarify one thing that I don't believe was clarified during this call. I think there was a lot of people that were speaking about a different pipeline as opposed to the NESE pipeline. And I think whether that was confusion, purposefully or not by some of the callers, I'm not quite sure.

But, I did want to mention one of the options, which was this LNG option, which is totally unrealistic. It's one of the options posed by National Grid. An LNG facility would require coordination from multiple state and federal agencies. Historically, LNG projects have faced tremendous local and environmental opposition. And, you know, if this were to be an option it'd take at least five to eight years for a facility like this to be constructed. And you know, so, I just wanted to touch on that as well as obviously, there's a bunch of other options that have been laid out.

I think it's pretty clear after reading a little bit about them, that the only option is the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project which, again, I believe most of callers that were calling in were referencing a different project in Brooklyn. Not this project that actually never even touches land. So, I would just like to add that to the record. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Vincent). Any additional callers on the line?

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Again, as a reminder those transcripts will be available and are available from our March 9 meeting as well as all of the meetings, subsequent meetings,

will also be available as well. We invite you to go to Ingrid.com/longtermsolutions to upload a written statement, or to provide any other questions directly to the Public Service Commission. And as well on the same Web site, there is information about our customer assistance program for both residential as well as commercial customers on that site as well.

I will do another call to see whether or not there are any remaining callers online waiting to provide comment.

Coordinator: I have no callers at this time. It is star one if anyone would like to have their line open. And please record your name in order to be introduced. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: As a reminder, again, please go to our Web site to upload any statements, additional statements and, or comments or questions at Ingrid.com/longtermsolutions. And again, the transcripts for our March meeting is already available and subsequent will also be available on the same Web site. As well as information about our customer assistance program. And as well, please know and share a customer can provide a written letter to the Public Service Commission as that information was also included as a part of our (unintelligible).

Any additional questions or comments? Not questions, comments. Callers waiting on line?

Coordinator: Yes, I do have a couple. (Kevin LaCherra), your line is open if you would please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Kevin LaCherra): (Kevin LaCherra), Greenpoint, Brooklyn 11222. I just figured since we have another 20 minutes and I'm glad there are a couple more people that want to

call in. But, just I would just like to read briefly from the community board one in Greenpoint, Brooklyn and Williamsburg, Brooklyn representative of our community here.

Adopted as resolution unanimously to oppose National Grids MRI pipeline and expansion of LNG in our community. You know, and so, I'll start, "Brooklyn's menu board one opposes National Grid's proposed rate hike to expand frack gas infrastructure in our neighborhoods. In particular, we oppose national Grid's plans to spend $61 million dollars - rate payer dollars - to complete phase five of the Metropolitan Reliability Infrastructure Pipeline - spend, $31.5 million rate payer dollars to add portable LNG capabilities at the Greenpoint facility, spend $53 million rate payer dollars adding two new vaporizers to the Greenpoint LNG facility, spent $23 million rate payer dollars to replace two vaporizers at the Greenpoint LNG facility."

And remember this was adopted unanimously by the folks who represent our community here at the most local level. "We oppose these projects for the following reasons. This is not about modernizing our gas system for heating and cooking. This is about creating an excuse to charge rate payers more money and grow profits for National Grid shareholders.

The MRI project is a transmission pipeline. It will not service the community where it is being built where the heavily trafficked main thoroughfares are already stressed. Trucking routes for local businesses will be dug up. National Grid is also calling for an expansion of LNG and CNG in our community to serve as a transport hub to truck LNG to Long Island and Massachusetts. Shipping LNG by truck on our roads will put our communities at risk.

Each trucks are often called bomb trucks because LNG is highly volatile. These projects will hold us back from achieving our renewable energy goals. We should be mandating the replacement of all gas pipelines with shared geo thermal loops energy efficiency measures in our building. Gas pipe lines are not safe. According to the US Pipeline and Hazardous Safety Materials Administration, in 2016 and 2018 there was an average of 639 pipeline incidents per year resulting in 15 fatalities, 72 injuries and a cost to the public of nearly 600 million dollars.

Fracking exacerbates climate change. Gas infrastructure leaks methane, which is 86 to 101 times worse for atmosphere warming than carbon dioxide. Climate change is destroying the Earth's ability to sustain life and increasing methane emissions is only exacerbating this crisis." There are two more, but I see I'm past time. So, I just want to say that this was adopted unanimously by our community board. Voted on and passed on to the Public Service Commission.

And I want to make sure that everyone on this call and that (Mr. Bruckner) and the folks at National Grid are fully aware of this community stands in opposition to what they're trying to do.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Kevin). Any additional callers in line?

Coordinator: I do. I have (Karen White). Your line is open if you would please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Karen White): Hi, yes. My name is (Karen White) and I am self-representing. I am from 10024. As someone, a young person, a millennial that is going to be highly impacted by climate change, dedicated my entire education including my undergraduate where I did public policy degrees around climate change about

the policy there. My graduate studies doing legal studies about policy law and energy in particular. My Master's degree in energy regulation.

I've looked at this issue pretty directly, and what I would say is that the, you know, energy system is a complex, integrated system that requires being looked at from a very broad scope in order to get an idea of what gets us from where we are today to the green energy future that we all desperately need and want. And when I look at this conundrum that we're in, we need to just multiply and demand ways to meet that demand are, you know, sufficiently laid out in 118 pages of report it becomes very clear that the pipeline is the right solution. Not just from a safety solution because the trucks that would otherwise have to replace it on the road are going to make our communities less safe. Not from just the clean air perspective sending that, you know, fuel by pipeline is not going to have consequence transport (unintelligible) emissions and not just from the perspective of the fuel use.

Because in the case we are causing those that can switch from gas to oil, we in fact are doing ourselves a disservice. And in every one of those policies where they say temperatures and told customers shall be cause to make the decision to fuel switch, what we're say is we want in this society to make the decision to have those in our - those biggest plants that produce electricity -- let's say on the coldest day of the year -- switch to burning fuel oil in amazing amounts in order to meet the demand on those hours. Instead of continuing to be on natural gas until such time as we have the ability to replace that natural gas with a greener infrastructure with either, you know, renewable generated hydrogen that's processed through plants or something else.

So, I really encourage the population who are looking at this from a laymen's perspective to find people that you rely on that are educated as to the details and not just take it from an emotional perspective. Because I think we

ultimately want the same conclusion which is a future where we have enough power at reliable rates to sufficiently provide safety for our communities and economic growth for our families to enjoy and all of that. So, I support NESE pipeline and I think it's time that we step back a little bit from our hyper green positions and really think about the underlying components.

We are moving towards a green energy future. We need to get there, we need to take thoughtful, constructive steps along the way and this is one of them. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Karen). Thank you, (Karen). The next caller please.

Coordinator: I have no callers in the queue right now.

Melanie Littlejohn: All right, as we move to the final 10 minutes, again I'm going to reiterate what I've been sharing throughout the public comment section that certainly we encourage you to continue to provide your statements, ask your questions. And we encourage you to go to our Web site at Ingrid.com/longtermsolutions to certainly upload a statement, or to provide any other questions. And we will as well be sharing those with the public service commission.

Is I shared at the front of our public - our public comment section pull transcripts of not only our March 9 meeting are available today, but subsequent meetings and the transcripts thereof will also be provided on the same Web site. And then, certainly, finally, but not least we also have our customer assistance program and all of the information that's provided for both residential as well as commercial customers as well on that site. And finally, we encourage you to share the information with a neighbor who might not have access and, or availability to the internet.

And certainly, if they want to provide and write a letter to the public service commission, we encourage that as well. And that information, again, was provided to customers as a part of a bill statement insert. Any additional folks in line to provide comment?

Coordinator: I do have a few more. First up is (Steve Fox). Your line is open and please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Steve Fox): Hey, there. This is (Steve). My zip code is 11206. My affiliation is a community member and rate payer.

I just want to respond kind of to what the last person just said. I am also a person who has a Master's degree in public policy. I am also a person who has spent most of his career working in the energy sector and in public policy. I also am a person who used to buy into the concept of natural gas as a bridge fuel.

Now, natural gas, theoretically, is better than fuel oil if you burn it at the outset. However, when we look at emissions, we're not looking at the full picture. We're not looking at leakage. Now, there's some studies that say New York City is leaking at a rate upwards of, like - I've seen reports between eight and 12 percent of the gas that's coming into the grid in New York City being leaked.

Now, if that is true, and that's significantly worse in emissions, over 20 years then natural gas, in fact, is worse than coal would be. Now, there is no environmental excuse to switch residential customers to natural gas. It is the distribution network that is specifically leaking and the distribution network, specifically, that is the problem when it comes to emissions. So, thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Steve). Next caller please.

Coordinator: That is from (Lee Ziesche). Your line is open and please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Lee Ziesche): Hi, my name is (Lee Ziesche). I'm a National Grid rate payer living in Bedstuy 11216. I also work for the Sane Energy Project, we're party in the National Grid rate case right now. I want to address three things right quick.

One, earlier (John Bruckner) said that this call was getting a lot more people on than in person meetings. And I think that's because he's never been to a meeting here out in Rockaways where those meetings were packed with residents to oppose the William's Pipeline. Secondly, there was a caller earlier who said he thought maybe people were confused because they were mentioning the MRI pipeline, also known as the North Brooklyn pipeline.

That pipeline was mentioned in the report that the independent auditors mentioned as a short term solution for this problem. But also, National Grid never went to that community - the north Brooklyn community - to get that community's permission to build this pipeline. So I think a lot of people are very frustrated and don't have another option except right now to address the president of National Grid and this company.

And third, I missed a little bit of (Steve's) comment because I got cut off to join and comment. But, I've been to Pennsylvania many times and I've met the people on the other end of this pipeline and they are getting poisoned right now. Also, a lot of the leakage rates he talked about, you know, is very serious. We're seeing a huge increase of Methane in our atmosphere.

And in a 20 year time frame that is worse than CO2. And we know from the rate case that almost all of national grid's methane accounting just comes from EPA estimates, which comes from the fossil fuel industry. And when you look at independent researchers like Bob Howarth -- from Cornell who is now on the climate action council -- who will be, kind of, advising us how we should be implementing the CLCPA, our climate laws, he's seeing much, much higher leakage rates.

So, this comes 100 percent from science, not feelings. And I just also want to appreciate everyone from the communities who have been calling in tonight to, you know, in this really hard time where we don't have a lot of extra time, to be fighting for their community. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you. Any additional callers?

Coordinator: Yes, next is (Craig Shear). Your line is open and please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Craig Shear): Hi, I am with Toughy Brothers in Manhattan at 10022 and at home in (unintelligible) 7302. Just a couple comments following up on some of the other issue that have been raised. The concerns are about the entire grid and emissions and the implications that has. The energy industry -- just like technology, just like everything else, -- gets more efficient over time as things become important and people are aware of it. Efforts are made to improve things.

Certainly, there are massive emission reduction measures being taken and proposed on the (unintelligible) pipeline. And there's little doubt that everything new being constructed is the best possible technology with the least amount of released gas. As a result, we really get the benefits of the

reduced cost of energy for rate payers in addition to the massively reduced emissions, versus the fuel oil being burned right now.

Unless there's a process that can actually, you know, eliminate the need to burn fuel oil in coming years and also alleviate the economic hardship on rate payers, it's hard to imagine how anyone can conciably (sic) turn down an opportunity, for win win that will bring lower emissions and lower cost to these communities and to our tri state area.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Craig). Any remaining callers online?

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay, so as we kind of wrap up for tonight, again I'm going to go back through a couple of the key - the key items. Please go to nationalingrid.com/longtermsolutions to upload written statements, or to provide any additional questions and those will also be provided directly to the public service commission. As well, the full transcripts of the March 9 meeting as well as the meeting - the subsequent meetings will also be housed on that same Web site.

As well as the information about our customer assistant program both residential as well as our commercial programs as well. So, as we wrap up and conclude the comment period for this evening, I want to say thank you and thank you for joining us tonight. The feedback and the questions that are - that have been collected this evening is a valuable, valuable part of the public input process. National Grid plans to issue a supplemental report in late April that will reflect all of the comments that we received.

All to enable an agreed long term solution, or solutions, within New York State by June 2020. This timeline will enable the solution, or solutions to be in place and operational by winter of 21, 22. And as a reminder, if you have further questions or input, please provide it directly to the public service commission, or certainly on our Web site.

We have instructions for how to do so to the public service commission as well as on our Web site as well. That concludes tonight's call. We thank you for your participation. Have a good, safe and healthy evening. Thank you.

Coordinator: Thank you. That does conclude today's conference and you may disconnect at this time. Thank you.

END